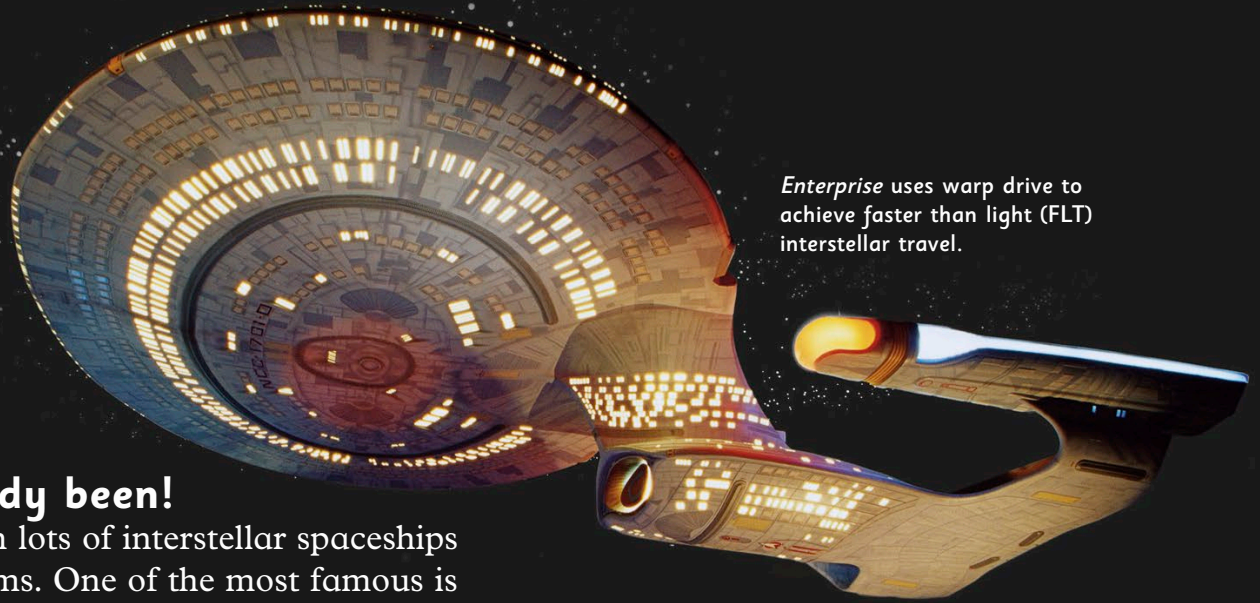
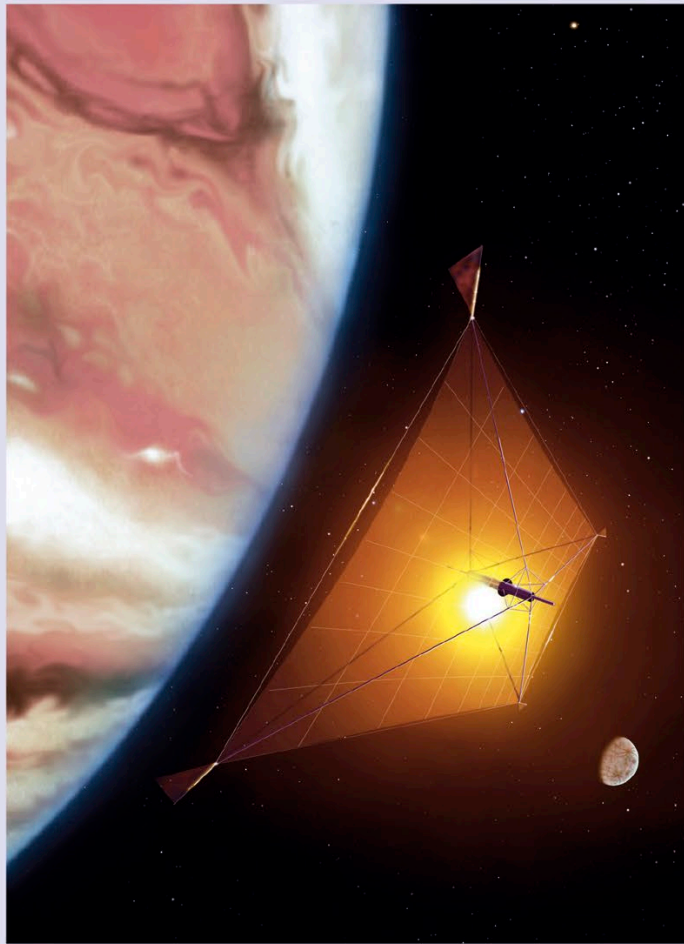




Enterprise uses warp drive to achieve faster than light (FLT) interstellar travel.

We've already been!

There have been lots of interstellar spaceships in books and films. One of the most famous is the *Star Ship Enterprise*, from *Star Trek*.



Are there other ways?

Recently, scientists have looked at using laser-powered solar sails for interstellar travel. The sail would have to be huge to collect enough energy to power the craft. It would move along because of the force of light bouncing off it. It would be helped along by powerful lasers aimed at the (mirrored) sail.

The reality

The Earth's Moon is about 1.25 light seconds away. Our fastest manned spacecraft takes three days to reach it. The fastest spacecraft built to date, *Helios 2*, would take some 19,000 years to reach our nearest star, Proxima Centauri (4.23 light years away).



The Earth is a long way from its neighbours in terms of possible space travel.